

LLM Solutions

Switching to Claude from ChatGPT?

Fix these 3 privacy settings right now

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When I switched from ChatGPT to Claude, I did what most people probably do. I simply just signed in and started chatting with the AI tool. I was purely focused on testing its responses rather than digging through the settings menu. For the first few days, I hardly considered the privacy controls or other settings that make an impact on the user experience. Then, while exploring the app, I came across a few settings that made me pause. Some were turned on by default and others were features I wanted to learn more about before deciding whether to keep them.

1. Location metadata

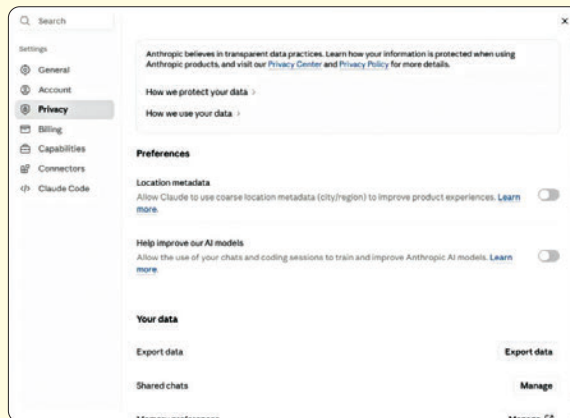
The first setting I strolled through and was shocked to know was enabled by default was the location metadata. I immediately wondered why Claude needed access to my location, so I went to read the explanation.

Anthropic says Claude can use your IP address to estimate your location and provide more relevant responses, such as nearby places, local recommendations, and weather information.

Although the function does seem reasonable if you are using Claude fre-

quently for such searches. However, if I require directions, weather updates, or even restaurant recommendations, I rely on Google Maps or Google Search. It didn't really make sense to give access to my location since I wasn't using the additional data.

So I decided to turn it off, and if you're anything like me and don't rely



on Claude for location-based answers, you may want to do the same. To do so, all you need to do is open Claude > go to Settings > select Privacy > find Location Metadata > toggle it off.

2. Help Improve Claude

Up next, I made sure that the Help Improve Claude feature is disabled on Claude. This feature allows Anthropic to use conversations and feedback to improve its AI systems. While some users may be perfectly comfortable contributing their chats to

help improve the platform. I wasn't. Most of my conversations involve research, writing ideas, work-related tasks, and planning. More importantly, those conversations are still mine, and I'd rather keep them that way.

For me, it comes down to control, as when I'm discussing article ideas, organising notes, or brainstorming projects, I don't want to wonder whether those conversations might be used for future training purposes.

If you use Claude for work, studies, writing, or personal projects, it's worth asking yourself a simple question: 'Are you comfortable with your conversations being used to improve the service?'. If the answer is no, then all you need to do is head to Claude > open Settings > select Privacy > locate Help Improve Claude > turn it off.

3. Incognito mode

Unlike the previous two settings, this isn't something I keep turned on or off all the time. Instead, I decide whether to use it whenever I need it. Incognito Mode is built into Claude and lets you start conversations that stay separate from your regular chats.

When I first found it, I thought it was one of those features that people can easily miss, but it's very useful.

There are times when I want a conversation to stay separate. Sometimes I might be exploring a personal topic, talking about a sensitive work issue, or asking questions that I don't want mixed in with my regular chats.

That's when Incognito Mode can help. It's very easy to use; just click the Incognito icon on the top left corner of the screen when starting a new chat and begin your conversation.

You may never need it every day, but knowing it's available means you have another privacy tool ready whenever the situation calls for it. 

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